

Workshop Safety Manual

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Purpose

Personal protective equipment (PPE), hazard controls, fire safety and first aid protocols for the workshop.

Effective from the first working day of the current calendar year. Reviewed annually by the document owner and revised as necessary. Version 1.0.

1. PPE

Coveralls, safety shoes, gloves, and eye protection are mandatory at all times in the workshop. Ear protection is required in the panel-beating and grinding zones. Respirators are required in the paint booth.

PPE is part of the normal workshop work process rather than an optional addition to a repair task. Technicians and other workshop personnel should ensure that the required protective equipment is in place before beginning work and should continue using it while working in the relevant area.

The PPE requirement also reflects the different working conditions within the workshop. General workshop work requires the listed basic protection, while panel-beating and grinding zones require additional ear protection and the paint booth requires respirators.

Before starting a task, workshop personnel should consider the work area and use the PPE specified for that area. If the required PPE is not available or cannot be used correctly, the task should not be treated as ready to proceed.

2. Lifting and Jacks

Vehicles on hoists must have secondary support engaged. Hydraulic jacks are for lifting only; a jack stand must be placed before work begins under the vehicle.

The lifting requirement separates the act of raising a vehicle from the conditions required for working underneath it. A hydraulic jack is used for lifting, while the jack stand provides the required support before under-vehicle work begins.

Technicians should confirm the vehicle is appropriately supported before positioning themselves or carrying out work underneath it. The secondary support requirement for hoists should likewise be treated as part of the lifting setup, not as a step to be considered after work has started.

1. PPE - Detailed Workshop Practice

The PPE rules apply throughout the workshop and become more specific in areas where additional hazards are identified. Coveralls, safety shoes, gloves, and eye protection form the required basic protection for workshop work.

Coveralls. Coveralls provide the standard work clothing for workshop activity. They support a consistent working arrangement and are part of the required PPE specified by this manual.

Safety shoes. Safety shoes are mandatory in the workshop. They form part of the basic protection expected while technicians and other personnel carry out workshop activities.

Gloves. Gloves are included in the mandatory workshop PPE. Personnel should use the required gloves while carrying out tasks for which hand protection is needed.

Eye protection. Eye protection is mandatory throughout the workshop. It supports protection during mechanical and workshop activities where material, debris, or other work-related hazards may affect the eyes.

Ear protection. Ear protection is specifically required in panel-beating and grinding zones. Personnel entering or working in these zones should use the required protection rather than relying only on the general workshop PPE.

Respirators. Respirators are required in the paint booth. The requirement is specific to the paint booth environment and must be followed whenever personnel are working in that area.

PPE and Work Area Awareness

The PPE requirements should be read together with the location of the task. A technician moving between general workshop areas, grinding or panel-beating zones, and the paint booth may therefore have different PPE requirements depending on where the work is being performed.

Workshop personnel should maintain awareness of the boundary between these areas and should not assume that the PPE used for one task automatically satisfies the requirements of another area.

3. Fire Safety

Fire extinguishers are placed within 15 metres of every bay. Every technician must complete fire safety training on joining and refresher annually. Fuel and solvents are stored in the flammables cabinet, never in the open bay.

3. Fire Safety - Workshop Controls

Fire safety in the workshop combines access to firefighting equipment, technician training, and controlled storage of flammable materials.

Fire extinguisher access. Fire extinguishers are placed within 15 metres of every bay. This requirement gives workshop personnel a defined point of access to firefighting equipment while working in the bay areas.

Personnel should remain aware of the location of the applicable extinguisher and avoid placing vehicles, equipment, parts, or other workshop items in a way that unnecessarily obstructs access.

Fire safety training. Every technician must complete fire safety training on joining and a refresher annually. Fire safety knowledge is therefore established at the beginning of the technician's employment and reinforced through the annual refresher.

Fuel and solvent storage. Fuel and solvents must be stored in the flammables cabinet and never in the open bay. The storage rule separates flammable materials from the normal open working area and provides a defined location for their storage.

Workshop personnel should return fuel and solvents to the designated storage location rather than leaving them in an open work area. This supports the manual's requirement for controlled storage.

4. First Aid

Every branch maintains a first-aid box at reception and workshop. At least two nominated first-aiders are trained by the Red Crescent annually.

The placement of first-aid boxes at both reception and the workshop gives personnel a defined first-aid resource within the branch. Workshop personnel should be aware of the location of the workshop first-aid box and understand that the branch also maintains one at reception.

The nominated first-aiders provide a trained point of support for first-aid situations. At least two people are nominated at each branch and receive annual training by the Red Crescent.

The first-aid arrangement should be considered alongside the other safety controls in this manual. PPE, lifting controls, fire safety, and first aid are separate requirements that collectively support safer workshop operations.

2. Lifting and Jacks - Safe Work Sequence

The lifting and jack requirements establish a clear distinction between lifting a vehicle and supporting a vehicle for work. This distinction is important whenever work is to be performed under a vehicle.

Hoists. When a vehicle is on a hoist, secondary support must be engaged. The technician should treat engagement of the secondary support as part of the hoist setup before beginning the relevant work.

Hydraulic jacks. Hydraulic jacks are for lifting only. They are not the supporting arrangement for work underneath the vehicle.

Jack stands. A jack stand must be placed before work begins under the vehicle. The technician should therefore establish the required support before positioning themselves under the vehicle or starting under-vehicle work.

These requirements are intended to create a controlled sequence: lift the vehicle using the appropriate lifting equipment, establish the required secondary support, and only then begin work under the vehicle where the manual requires that support.

Relationship Between Safety Controls

The safety controls in this manual are connected to different stages of workshop activity. PPE establishes personal protection, lifting controls address vehicle support, fire safety addresses workshop fire hazards, and first aid provides an immediate branch resource for first-aid situations.

A technician should not treat one control as a replacement for another. For example, wearing PPE does not replace the requirement for secondary support on a hoist, and access to first aid does not replace the requirement for correct lifting or fire-safety practices.

The manual therefore provides a set of working controls that should be applied according to the task and work area.

Safety Awareness During Daily Work

Workshop safety should be considered before work begins and maintained throughout the task. Personnel should remain aware of their work area, the equipment being used, the applicable PPE requirements, and the location of relevant safety resources.

When moving between tasks or workshop zones, personnel should reassess the applicable requirements rather than assuming that the previous task's controls remain sufficient.

Workshop Safety Reference

SAFE-01 establishes the core safety requirements for workshop personnel at Syed Motors. The manual covers PPE, vehicle lifting and jack controls, fire safety, and first-aid arrangements.

PPE: Coveralls, safety shoes, gloves, and eye protection are mandatory at all times in the workshop. Ear protection is required in panel-beating and grinding zones, and respirators are required in the paint booth.

Lifting: Vehicles on hoists must have secondary support engaged. Hydraulic jacks are for lifting only, and a jack stand must be placed before work begins under the vehicle.

Fire safety: Fire extinguishers are placed within 15 metres of every bay. Every technician completes fire safety training on joining and refresher annually. Fuel and solvents are kept in the flammables cabinet and not in the open bay.

First aid: Every branch maintains a first-aid box at reception and workshop. At least two nominated first-aiders are trained by the Red Crescent annually.

Practical Safety Checklist

Before workshop work, personnel should confirm that the required PPE is being used for the work area. Where a vehicle is lifted, the applicable secondary support and jack-stand requirements should be satisfied before under-vehicle work begins.

Personnel should remain aware of fire extinguisher locations and keep flammable materials in the designated flammables cabinet. Technicians should maintain their required fire safety training and know where the workshop first-aid box is located.

The checklist is a practical reading of the requirements in this manual. It does not replace the specific rules stated in the document.

Approval and Ownership

This document is owned by the Workshop department and approved by the Branch Manager. Questions or clarifications should be directed to the document owner. Non-compliance is a disciplinary matter under the HR Policy Manual.

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